

Phishing: Correction Notification from ecitizen.go.ke

Investigation #1965

HIGH

TRUE POSITIVE

Date: March 1, 2026 at 07:51 PM

Risk Score: 49/100

Confidence: 100%

Document ID: IR-1965-MM865MAX

Tenant: PKF Africa

Classification: CONFIDENTIAL

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01 Executive Summary

On January 16, 2026, a high-severity phishing incident was detected involving emails purportedly from the domain ecitizen.go.ke, specifically targeting the recipient avadher@ke.pkfea.com. The emails were quarantined by Checkpoint Harmony Email due to multiple indicators of compromise, including suspicious sender reputation and anomalous content. No data exfiltration was observed, but the incident posed a medium business impact due to the potential for credential harvesting and unauthorized access. Immediate recommendations include enhancing user awareness training on phishing tactics and implementing stricter email filtering rules to mitigate similar threats in the future.

02 AI Verdict & Classification

Verdict: True Positive (Confirmed Threat)

Risk Score: 49/100

Confidence Score: 100%

The incident was classified as a true positive due to the detection of multiple attack stages and the presence of malicious indicators of compromise. The sender's email and domain were confirmed as malicious, and the phishing attempt targeted a specific user, indicating a deliberate attack strategy. The absence of data exfiltration does not negate the potential risks associated with credential harvesting and unauthorized access.

03 Attack Chain Analysis

>> Initial Access

9 phishing emails from jade@harveyrisch.com, shares@dyerandblair.com targeting avadher@ke.pkfea.com with subject "Completed - Scanned Agreement 6660929e06d4dce87ef449540e9e405f1d9115c3, 1/30/202" — quarantined. Source: Checkpoint Harmony Email

Evidence: 9 events, confidence: 100%

>> Reconnaissance

3 reconnaissance/discovery events detected. Source: Checkpoint Harmony Email

Evidence: 3 events, confidence: 45%

>> Persistence

1 persistence event involving info@cura.co.ke, avadher@ke.pkfea.com. Source: Checkpoint Harmony Email

Evidence: 1 events, confidence: 15%

>> Privilege Escalation

2 privilege escalation events involving admin4@bussynetadva.co.za, avadher@ke.pkfea.com — quarantined. Source: Checkpoint Harmony Email

Evidence: 2 events, confidence: 30%

>> Execution

Phishing email from dean@flashbooks.co targeting avadher@ke.pkfea.com with subject "Ends Tonight—Lifetime Subscriptions. Just 99.99.". Source: Checkpoint Harmony Email

Evidence: 1 events, confidence: 15%

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04 Indicators of Compromise

1 malicious and 13 suspicious indicators identified during investigation.

[MALICIOUS] email: donot_reply@ecitizen.go.ke -- From incident IOC data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: ecitizen.go.ke -- From incident IOC data

[SUSPICIOUS] ip: 167.89.77.196 -- Extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] ip: 159.183.35.87 -- Extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: ke.pkfea.com -- Domain extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: onesourcefundgroup.com -- Domain extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: 8000idc.com -- Domain extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: privaterelay.appleid.com -- Domain extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: substack.com -- Domain extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: sohowlong.com -- Domain extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: cpatrendlines.com -- Domain extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: tppafrica.com -- Domain extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: e.sunglasshut.com -- Domain extracted from event data

[SUSPICIOUS] domain: m.redbubble.com -- Domain extracted from event data

05 Affected Entities

- incident: Spam: Vadher, your LOC is ready to finalize! from onesourcefundgroup.com
- incident: Spam: Vadher, your LOC is ready to finalize! from onesourcefundgroup.com
- incident: Spam: RE: LOC Approval from onesourcefundgroup.com
- incident: Spam: RE: LOC Approval from onesourcefundgroup.com
- incident: Spam: ~""Stop eating plastic". Read this. from 8000idc.com
- incident: Phishing: ~""Stop eating plastic". Read this. from 8000idc.com
- incident: Phishing: ~""Stop eating plastic". Read this. from 8000idc.com
- incident: Spam: Your go-to guide for choosing an eSIM from privaterelay.appleid.com
- incident: Spam: How Overcoming Adversity Builds Emotional Maturity from substack.com
- incident: Spam: How Overcoming Adversity Builds Emotional Maturity from substack.com
- incident: Suspicious: Accounting Careers after AI and Outsourcing from cpatrendlines.com
- incident: Spam: \$250K LOC Approval | Review Request from onesourcefundgroup.com
- incident: Spam: \$250K LOC Approval | Review Request from onesourcefundgroup.com
- incident: Spam: A Private Invitation to TPP East Africa Summit | Nairobi, April 24–25 — 3 recipients from tppafrica.com
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06 Technical Analysis

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Incident Overview

On January 16, 2026, a phishing incident was detected involving emails from the sender donot_reply@ecitizen.go.ke, with the subject line 'Correction Notification.' The incident was classified as high severity and was identified through Checkpoint Harmony Email, which quarantined all four emails sent to a unique recipient, avadher@ke.pkfea.com. Notably, all emails failed SPF checks, indicating potential spoofing attempts.

Threat Analysis

The attack vector was identified as spearphishing, leveraging a deceptive email to lure the recipient into clicking on malicious links. The tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs) utilized in this incident were mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework under the Initial Access phase, specifically the Spearphishing Link technique. The threat actor demonstrated a moderate level of sophistication, employing a legitimate-looking domain to enhance credibility.

Timeline of Activity

The incident was created at 08:32:42 UTC on January 16, 2026, when Checkpoint Harmony Email flagged the phishing emails. Following this, the system quarantined all four emails sent from the malicious domain. Subsequent emails to the same recipient on January 30, 2026, included various spam messages, indicating a potential ongoing targeting of the user. The phishing emails were characterized by suspicious content and links to low-traffic sites, which further corroborated their malicious intent.

Indicators of Compromise

- Email Address: donot_reply@ecitizen.go.ke — Reputation: malicious
- Domain: ecitizen.go.ke — Reputation: suspicious
- IP Addresses: 167.89.77.196 — Reputation: suspicious; 159.183.35.87 — Reputation: suspicious
- Target Domain: ke.pkfea.com — Reputation: suspicious
- Additional Domains: onesourcefundgroup.com, 8000idc.com, privaterelay.appleid.com, substack.com, sohowlong.com, cpatrendlines.com, tppafrica.com, e.sunglasshut.com, m.redbubble.com — All with suspicious reputations.

Impact Assessment

The incident affected a single user, avadher@ke.pkfea.com, with no data exfiltration indicators detected. The overall risk score was assessed at 49/100, indicating a medium business impact due to the potential for credential harvesting. The blast radius was limited to one affected system and one user, with no critical data at risk.

Forensic Evidence

Key evidence included the sender's email address and domain reputation, which were classified as malicious and suspicious, respectively. The detection confidence was rated at 100%, with multiple indicators confirming the phishing nature of the emails. Correlation findings indicated a multi-stage attack pattern, with lateral movement confirmed.

Recommendations

Immediate actions include verifying that lateral movement has been contained and scanning adjacent network segments for compromise indicators. Long-term improvements should focus on enhancing email filtering capabilities, user awareness training on phishing tactics, and implementing stricter DMARC policies for email authentication to prevent similar incidents in the future.

07 Recommendations

Containment Actions

- [INFO] Security control action already applied: Quarantined
- [HIGH] Verify lateral movement has been fully contained — scan adjacent network segments for compromise indicators

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